

A group of diverse students, including a woman in the foreground holding a smartphone high to take a selfie, are smiling and posing for a photo. They are standing in front of a building with traditional Chinese architectural features, such as wooden railings and lanterns. The scene is brightly lit, suggesting an outdoor setting during the day.

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CSPL 252

PERSONAL IMPACT PLAN

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Introduction

The journey to creating meaningful social impact begins with understanding the self, the issue at hand, and the best pathway to navigate challenges. This plan outlines my aspirations, informed by the tools learned throughout the course, including my person, problem and pathway to a solution, my power and network analysis, system mapping of my chosen problem area, a draft of my current mission, vision as well as examples of my agitation, innovation and orchestration experiences, as per Battilana's theory of social change agents. (Battilana and Kimsey, 2017). I will do this by sharing my reflections on case studies, personal experiences, and professional interests.

PROBLEM

According to Battilana et al, the 3P (problem, person, pathway) framework emphasizes the importance of aligning personal motivations (Person), systemic challenges (Problem), and strategic actions (Pathway) to drive social innovation. The first, problem, outlines the need at hand. Battilana et al (2017) recommend never presuming this, as it could lead to solving for a problem that is not the pain point of the target community. The problem I have identified is the lack of access of free, quality education to children in Lagos, Nigeria. The problem statement goes thus:

"Underprivileged children in Nigeria need access to free quality education, to gain equal opportunit(ies) of attaining an excellent quality of life and standard of living."



In 2013, one in every five of the world's out-of-school children was in Nigeria. That number has nearly doubled to date, with twenty million children aged 5-14 years out of school. This, compounded with the low literacy rates (only 49%

of children in school achieve basic literacy proficiency, and 55% achieve basic numeracy proficiency) ("UNICEF Statistics On Education"), chronic poverty (on average 4 out of 10 individuals in Nigeria has real per capita expenditures below 137,430 Naira - \$85, per year) (National Bureau of Statistics), insecurity, and corruption in the country, effectively ensure that these children remain out of school until employment age. An analysis of these causes is found below:

Root Cause Analysis

Poverty and the Need for Income

According to Nigeria's National Bureau of Statistics, 40.1 percent of the total population was classified as poor in 2019. In other words, 4 out of 10 individuals in Nigeria had real per capita expenditures below 137,430 Naira (85 USD) per year. (National Bureau of Statistics) Many Nigerians cannot afford basic necessities like food, shelter and clothing. This means that these families are most likely occupied with sending their children to school, and instead send them to learn a trade, or sell wares in traffic.

The Statistical Information and Monitoring Programme on Child Labour Survey (SIMPOC) found approximately 15 million (15,027,612) working children in Nigeria: comprising six million (41%) who were not attending school, and another two million who were exposed to as long as 15 or more hours of work daily. Interestingly, the children in labour who were not attending school comprised 3,110,033 (51%) girls and 2,992,373 (49%) boys; indicating that this problem may be influenced by the sociocultural gender-based biases prevalent in the country.

Because the rate of poverty is so high, even the 'free' basic education is inaccessible to many individuals, as they must send their children to work to make ends meet. The implementation of the compulsory education act in Nigeria is lacking, leaving millions of children out of school and trading.

Corruption and Severe Underfunding of the Educational Sector

According to the 2023 Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) by Transparency International, Nigeria is the 35th most corrupt country in the world, with government officials often pillaging the country's resources instead of implementing them for policy implementation. (Transparency International) This largely contributes to the high poverty rate in the country, but also leads to a severe underfunding of the educational sector.

Many schools lack basic facilities, such as classrooms, furniture, and sanitation, making them less appealing or accessible. It is not uncommon for public school teachers to go months without being paid, leading to a shortage of qualified teachers, particularly in rural areas.

Nigeria consistently allocates less than 10% of its national budget to education, far below the UNESCO-recommended 15–20%. For example, in 2023, only 7.2% of the national budget was allocated to education, reflecting chronic underfunding. Even the limited funds allocated to education are often mismanaged or diverted due to corruption. Bribes, embezzlement, and favoritism in fund allocation contribute to the perpetuation of poorly funded schools, particularly in marginalized communities.

Economic Inequality in the Provision of Education

For years, the economic inequality in Nigeria has grown alarmingly stark. This is especially symptomatic in the educational sector, where the quality of education available to children is based on the amount of money their parents are able to pay. Expensive private schools - whose annual school fees for one pupil equate to two years' worth of school fees for two pupils in a public school - disseminate higher quality education: proven in their better, more modernised resources; including textbooks, gadgets (computers), and classroom equipment. These, as well as the greater access to educational opportunities (such as debate competitions, music opportunities, and exploration of different art forms), provide a sharp contrast to the economic insufficiency that is the case in many Nigerian public schools. Unfortunately, these are the only schools available to students from less economically privileged backgrounds.

Social and Cultural Barriers

Some parents see education as unnecessary, believing children should contribute to the family income instead. This view persists in regions with strong cultural biases toward child labor and early marriage. Additionally, cultural norms often limit girls' access to education, as many families prioritize educating boys. Girls are often expected to marry early and have children, severely limiting their educational continuity. In some cultures, religious leaders and communities view Western-style education with suspicion, associating it with the erosion of cultural and religious values.

Who Benefits from the Status Quo?



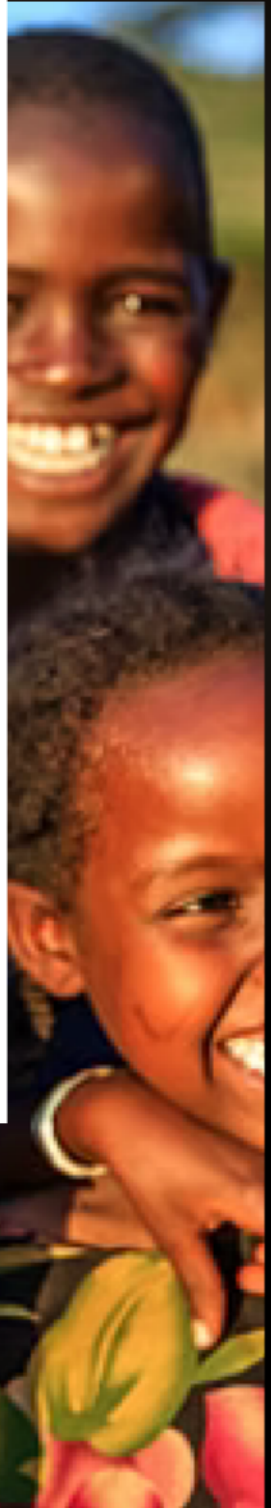
- **Families in need of income:** Many families cannot survive without the income coming in from their children practicing a vocation or hawking goods in the markets. They benefit economically from their children not being in school.

- **Corrupt Government Officials:** Government officials and law makers who embezzle the funds meant for the educational sector benefit from sending their children to luxurious schools abroad and securing generational wealth for their families illegally on national resources. They benefit economically from Nigerian children not being in school.
- **Neo-colonial Powers that be:** There are increasing reports of western countries that exacerbate insecurity and unrest in African countries to slow their development. It may be in the best interest of these powers that many Nigerian children remain uneducated and less empowered to develop and transform the country into one that can compete on an international stage.
- **Cultural Community Leaders and Families + Spouses of Child Brides:** Many cultural community leaders in rural areas, who prioritize tradition, frown upon western education and its implications from colonizations. Girls are often exchanged for cows, goats, chickens and tubers of yam, and are forced to produce male children for the man who paid their dowry. The families of these girls benefit from economic stability of their new spouses and reduced cost in their households, cultural community leaders benefit from maintaining problematic traditional beliefs, and spouses benefit from the children and domestic work girls produce instead of going to school.

Immersion in Problem Context

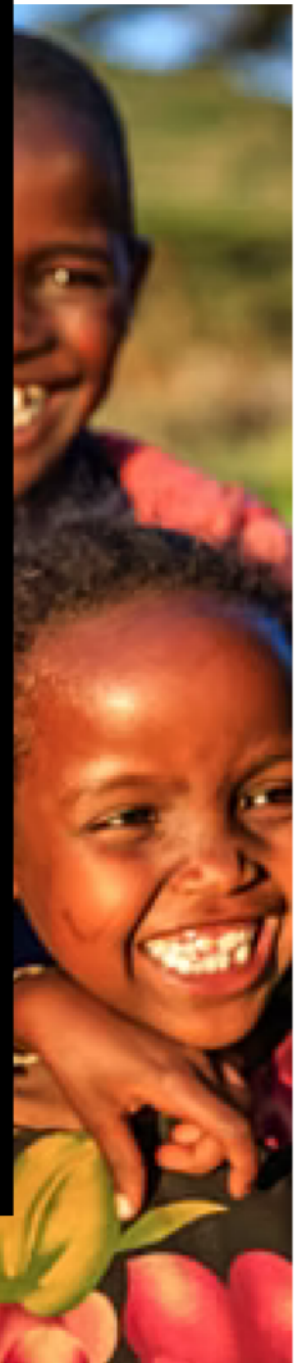
My experience growing up in Lagos, Nigeria, has given me a level of understanding of the problem. Every day going to school, I would see scores of children just like me, unable to go to school. I went to an expensive private school on a scholarship - and was able to witness the stark differences in educational quality between the private and public school systems in Nigeria. Students at my school had imported textbooks, private tutors, and access to quality facilities. In contrast, some students in public schools often had to share textbooks - sometimes 5 students to one textbook - deal with overcrowded classrooms and dilapidated facilities (sometimes 70+ students fitting in one classroom), and underpaid teachers who sometimes treated them negatively due to untimely payment. Immersion in this context has given me deep insight to the gaps that need to be filled, as well as solutions that may be effective in solving the problem.

Additionally, my work with the Ekiunu Kiagbodo Kedo Foundation for orphans and widows, an organization that provides books and basic necessities to orphans and widows, has allowed me to directly engage with the communities most affected by educational inequity.



My mother also worked as a teacher at my high school - and later as middle management of an organization that increases educational access to children in Lagos. I've had the opportunity to understand the issues that hinder non-governmental organizations from effectively tackling the issue, including bureaucratic bottle necks and extra contractual lapses in payment. I've also had the opportunity to engage directly with the communities for which this a deep problem, and understand the pain points affecting them most. This valuable insight has given me unique positionality to the problem, and I have thus based my proposed solution from the context of being immersed in the problem.

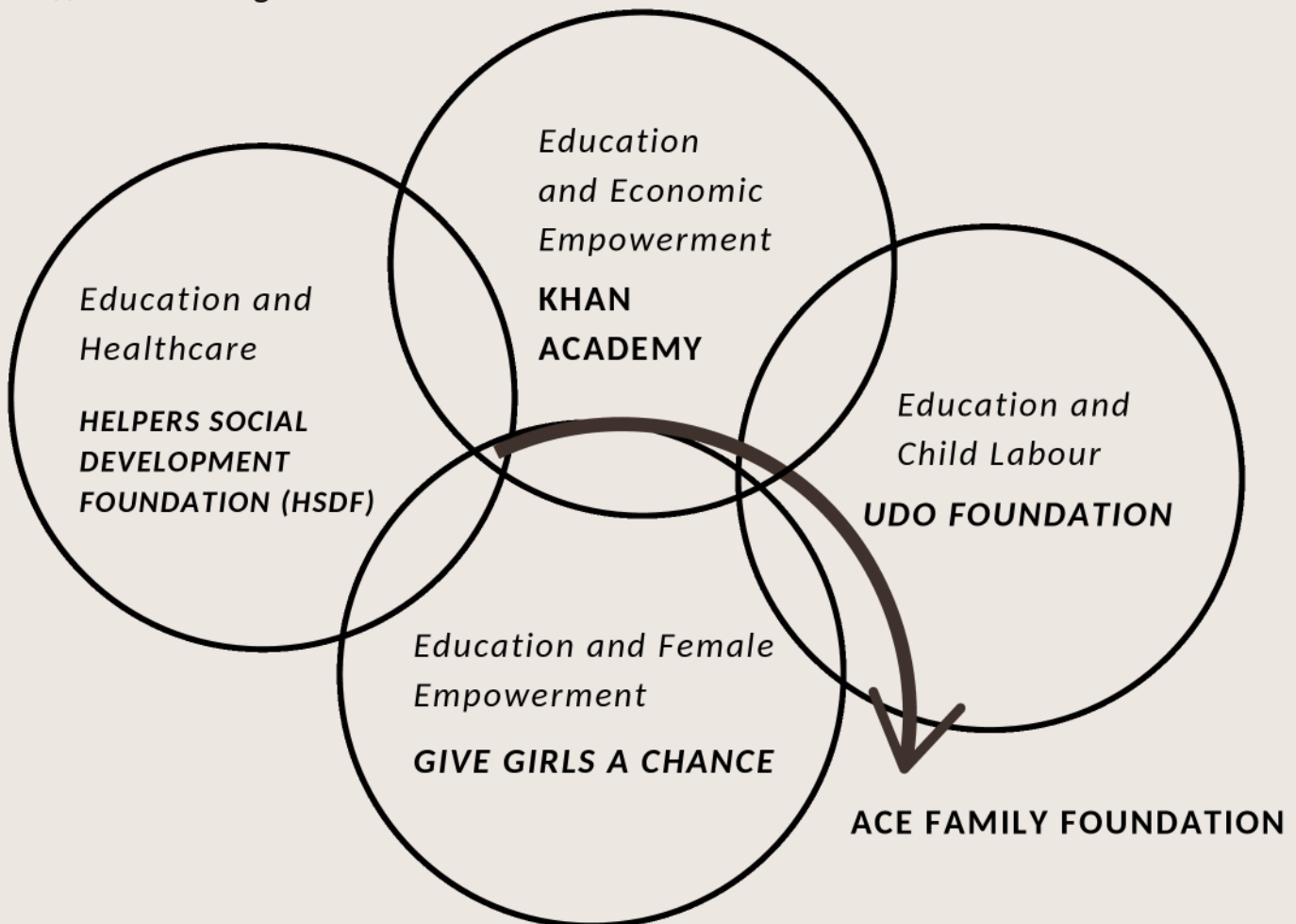
The Nigerian government, and indeed, governments across the African continent, have not proven themselves reliable at closing this gap. For Nigeria to catch up, school needs to be brought to the children. Edtech thus presents itself as a meaningful tool to address this issue. Historically, online educational platforms have not been prevalent across Nigeria - primarily because of lack of knowledge of their existence, but also due to lack of knowledge on how to use them. Education for Equality - my proposed solution, aims to change that. By decentralizing education and making it free for all children, we aim to fill educational and technological gaps in Nigeria.



Immersion in Problem Context

System Mapping

There remains a number of organizations working to increase educational access in and around Nigeria. The most notable players cover a wide berth of problems, including educational access, access to quality healthcare, economic empowerment, female empowerment, and child labour. In total, they cover five different SDG goals:



1. UDO FOUNDATION

UDO foundation (UDOF) has been a player in the educational access space for little less than a decade. Their primary goal is to empower underprivileged children through free quality education, with a mission of getting every child off the streets and in school. This is a great example of an organization solving the problem from the aspect of child hawking and its consequences, as discussed earlier. Their key activities include:

'Children off the Streets' Initiative: This program aims to enroll one hundred street children into schools by 2023, providing them with education and support to realize their potential.

Health and Nutrition: The foundation prioritizes children's well-being by offering healthcare services, nutritional support, and promoting healthy lifestyles to ensure proper development.

System Mapping

Creative Education and Counseling: UDOF collaborates with employers to offer children practical opportunities to apply classroom-acquired skills, fostering personal growth and self-esteem.

Shelter and Protection: UDOF provides safe environments for vulnerable children, partnering with local organizations to offer shelter and support to those affected by homelessness, abuse, or neglect.

Advocacy and Awareness: The foundation advocates for children's rights and raises awareness about their challenges, working with policymakers and community leaders to create lasting change.

2. GIVE GIRLS A CHANCE (GGAC)

Give Girls a Chance is committed to increasing young girls' access to quality education in Nigeria, recognizing that educating girls is a pivotal investment in the nation's future. GGAC directly supports girls in four secondary schools in the Abuja area, addressing issues related to access, awareness, and infrastructure. Their comprehensive approach ensures that more girls can pursue and complete their education. Some of their key activities include:

Scholarships and Mentorships: They provide financial assistance and guidance to girls in secondary schools, ensuring they have the resources and support needed to succeed.

Training and Workshops: Give Girls a Chance organizes sessions for primary school teachers in public schools to enhance teaching quality and effectiveness.

Reading Clubs: They also encourage literacy and a love for reading among young children through weekly clubs, increasing early childhood educational access.

3. ACE FAMILY FOUNDATION

ACE Family Foundation is a notable player in the field, with their key areas of focus intersecting at the helm of educational access, economic empowerment, and quality healthcare access, and female empowerment. The foundation has secured lifelong scholarships for over 200 children from indigent homes, providing them with opportunities for a brighter future. Collaborations with organizations like Chess.com and Lufthansa Airlines have expanded educational initiatives, broadening the foundation's reach and effectiveness. Their key are:

Learning Empowerment Program (ACE Radio School): In response to limited online learning access, this program broadcasts educational content to children, particularly in STEM subjects.

System Mapping

Business Empowerment Program for Women: This annual program equips women with essential sewing and business skills to start their own enterprises.

Mobile Clinics: To address healthcare disparities, the foundation operates mobile clinics that deliver free medical services to rural communities, enhancing overall health outcomes.

4. HELPERS SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT FOUNDATION (HDSF)

HDSF aims to provide free education to underprivileged children in Nigeria, with an ambitious goal to educate one million children by 2030. To date, they have distributed school supplies to over 1,800 pupils across various public schools in Enugu State, Nigeria. They have constructed sanitary facilities at Community Secondary School Ogbunka and Uwani River Primary School, improving hygiene and sanitation for students. In October 2021, they established a nursery and primary school in the Oji-River Local Government area, providing free education to children from low-income families. Additionally, HDSF has implemented community clean water projects, significantly improving health and sanitation in local communities. These are their key initiatives:

Nursery and Primary School: Operating a school in the Oji-River area of Enugu State, offering free education to children from low-income families.

Educational Materials Distribution: Providing learning and writing materials to orphans, widows, and less privileged children in public schools, enhancing their educational experience.

5. KHAN ACADEMY

Khan Academy is a non-profit organization with the mission to provide a free, world-class education to anyone, anywhere. Serving over 145 million registered users worldwide, Khan Academy offers more than 8,000 instructional videos and over 50,000 practice exercises. Students engaging with the platform for 30 minutes or more per week show approximately 20% higher-than-expected learning gains, demonstrating the effectiveness of their resources. These are their key initiatives:

Personalized Learning Platform: Offering instructional videos and practice exercises across various subjects, allowing learners to progress at their own pace.

Official SAT Practice: Providing free, personalized SAT preparation resources in partnership with the College Board, making standardized test preparation accessible to all.

Person



STORY AND MOTIVATIONS

GROWING UP IN LAGOS, NIGERIA, I ATTENDED MY SECONDARY SCHOOL BASED ON A SCHOLARSHIP AND A DISCOUNT BASED ON MY MOTHER'S SALARY AS A TEACHER. IN THE EARLY TIMES MY FAMILY DIDN'T HAVE FOOD TO EAT. HAVING THE PRIVILEGE TO GAIN A QUALITY EDUCATION, I KNEW THERE WAS NO DIFFERENCE BETWEEN ME AND MANY OF THE CHILDREN I SAW ON LAGOS ROADS; TRADING

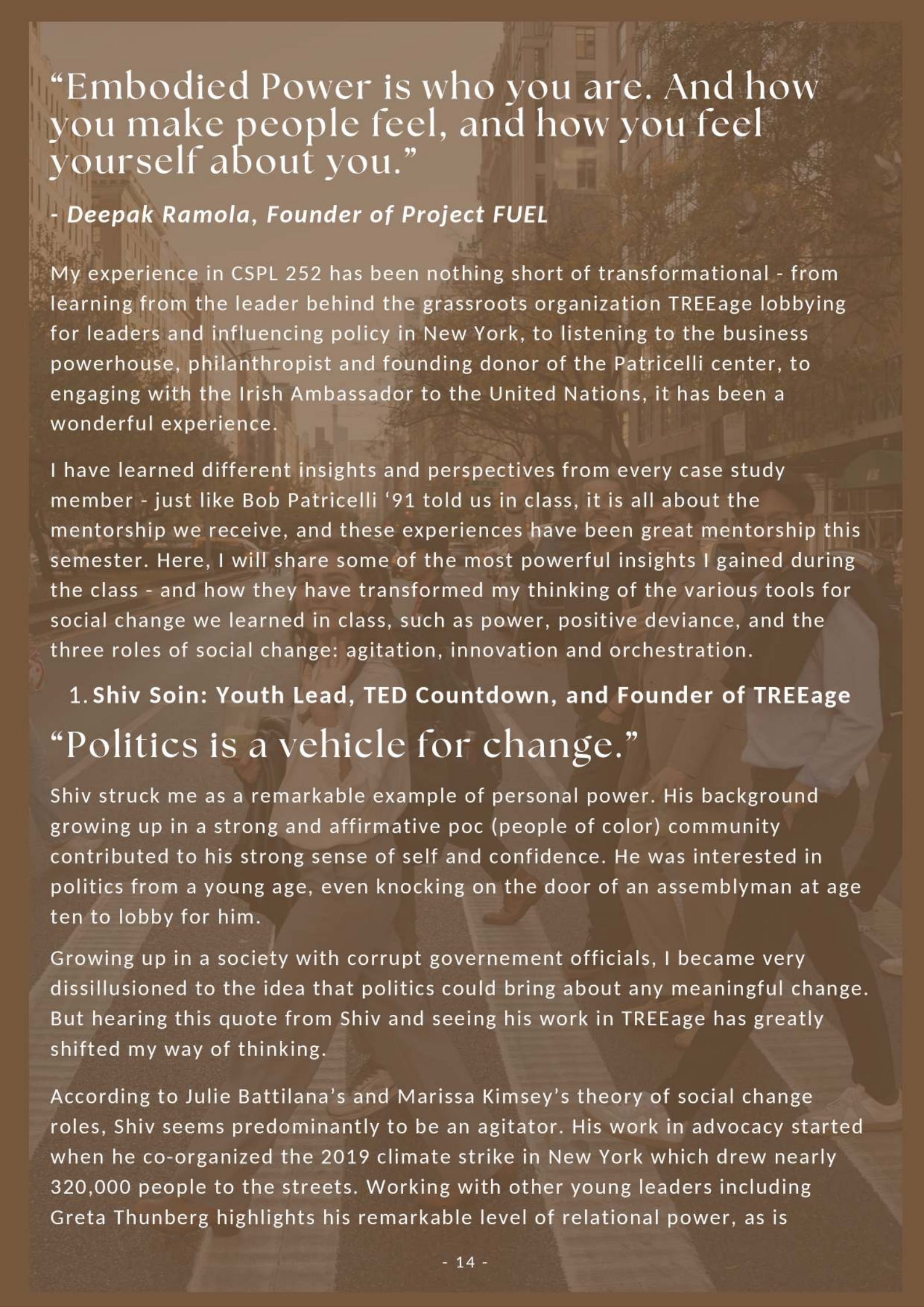
WARES OR FIXING CARS FOR THEIR FAMILIES TO SURVIVE. I KNEW THAT EDUCATION HAD A BIG ROLE TO PLAY IN WHERE MANY PEOPLE IN MY SOCIETY GOT TO LIVE AND THE OPPORTUNITIES THEY HAD ACCESS TO. IT WAS EVIDENT TO ME FROM A YOUNG AGE THAT THE NIGERIAN GOVERNMENT AND, INDEED, GOVERNMENTS ACROSS THE CONTINENT, HAD NOT PROVEN THEMSELVES RELIABLE AT CLOSING THE PREVALENT EDUCATIONAL GAP.

LOOKING ACROSS THE AFRICAN CONTINENT, I CAN SEE THAT OF THE MANY PROBLEMS OUR BEAUTIFUL CONTINENT HAS, THE EASIEST WAY TO SOLVE THEM IS THROUGH SINGLE UNITS: PEOPLE. IF WE CAN TEACH AFRICANS TO SOLVE PROBLEMS AROUND THEM, THEN WE CAN SET OFF A CHAIN REACTION OF TRANSFORMATION ACROSS THE CONTINENT. I AIM TO DO THIS BEGINNING WITH EDUCATION.

WITHOUT THE EXTREME SACRIFICES OF MY PARENTS, I WOULD NOT HAVE RECEIVED A QUALITY EDUCATION. I KNOW THAT MANY CHILDREN ACROSS MY COUNTRY, NIGERIA, AND THE AFRICAN CONTINENT, DO NOT HAVE THE SAME PRIVILEGE. AS A RESULT, FREE, QUALITY EDUCATION NEEDS TO BE MADE ACCESSIBLE TO THEM.



Casestudy Reflections



“Embodied Power is who you are. And how you make people feel, and how you feel yourself about you.”

- **Deepak Ramola, Founder of Project FUEL**

My experience in CSPL 252 has been nothing short of transformational - from learning from the leader behind the grassroots organization TREEage lobbying for leaders and influencing policy in New York, to listening to the business powerhouse, philanthropist and founding donor of the Patricelli center, to engaging with the Irish Ambassador to the United Nations, it has been a wonderful experience.

I have learned different insights and perspectives from every case study member - just like Bob Patricelli '91 told us in class, it is all about the mentorship we receive, and these experiences have been great mentorship this semester. Here, I will share some of the most powerful insights I gained during the class - and how they have transformed my thinking of the various tools for social change we learned in class, such as power, positive deviance, and the three roles of social change: agitation, innovation and orchestration.

1. Shiv Soin: Youth Lead, TED Countdown, and Founder of TREEage

“Politics is a vehicle for change.”

Shiv struck me as a remarkable example of personal power. His background growing up in a strong and affirmative poc (people of color) community contributed to his strong sense of self and confidence. He was interested in politics from a young age, even knocking on the door of an assemblyman at age ten to lobby for him.

Growing up in a society with corrupt government officials, I became very disillusioned to the idea that politics could bring about any meaningful change. But hearing this quote from Shiv and seeing his work in TREEage has greatly shifted my way of thinking.

According to Julie Battilana's and Marissa Kimsey's theory of social change roles, Shiv seems predominantly to be an agitator. His work in advocacy started when he co-organized the 2019 climate strike in New York which drew nearly 320,000 people to the streets. Working with other young leaders including Greta Thunberg highlights his remarkable level of relational power, as is

evidenced by his work in TREEage. Working with youth in New York, he demonstrates remarkable positive deviance everyday by leveraging his personal and positional power to choose those that will lead his city, New York. He thus uses politics as a vehicle for not just political, but social change.

2. Kuoth Wiel: Actor, Model, and Founder of Janubi Butter

“Wherever I go, I’m always telling a story.”

Kuoth is another remarkable example of personal power. Her story and confidence truly inspired me - especially her ability to kindly, confidently, and with discretion, communicate her values, standards and morals. I truly appreciated her sense of self-security, and, like her quote, I could see the story of Sudanese people she was trying to tell. It was one of courage, resilience, and beauty.

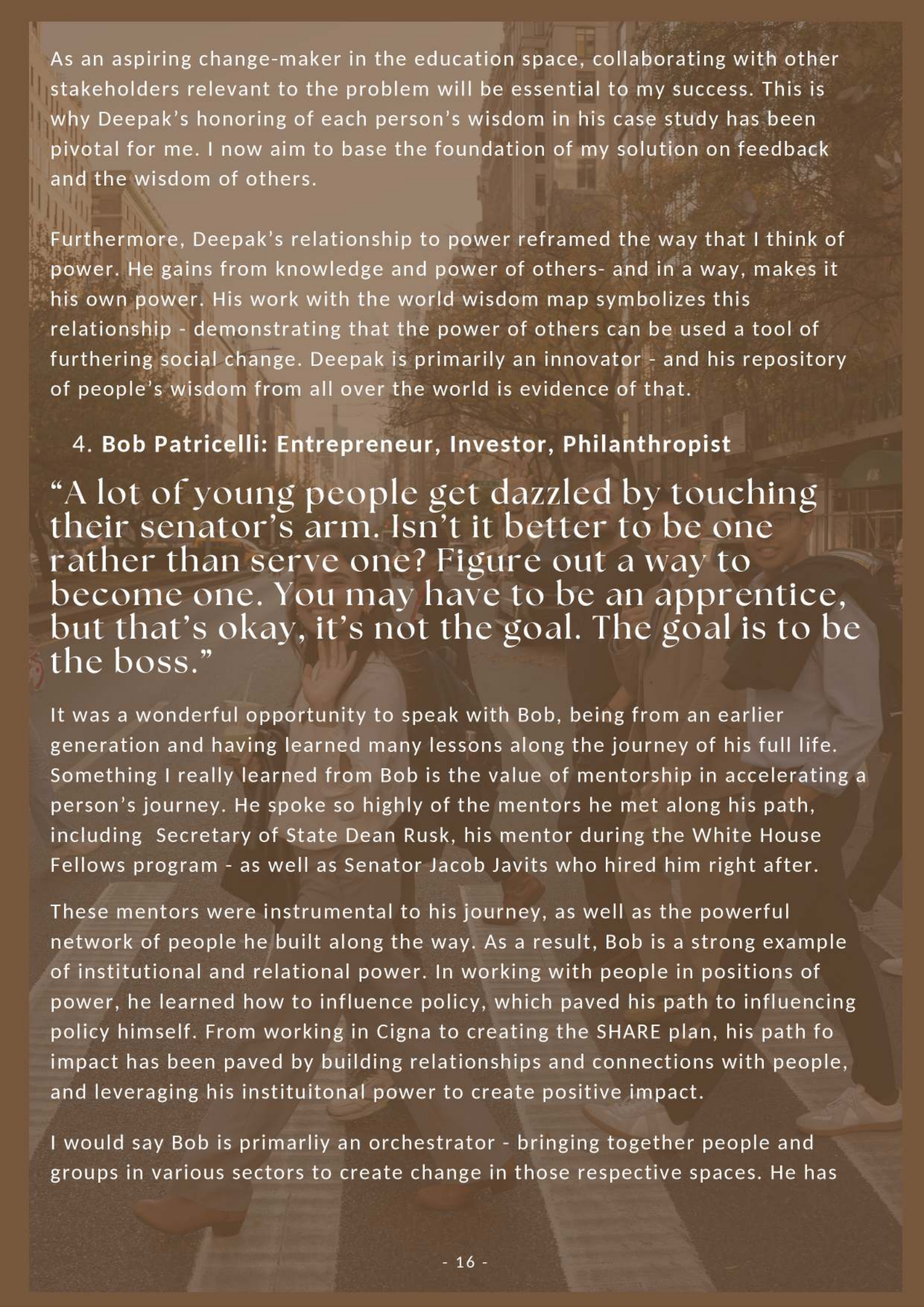
As a young African coming to college in the U.S., I could relate to a lot of the things she shared about feeling lonely and isolated - and taking on an identity that might not necessarily be my own. In my social change journey, Kuoth has demonstrated that it is possible to take control of my own story - and been a wonderful example of how to do that. No matter the power I may have in relation to society or the problem I’m trying to solve - it is possible to represent that myself and that problem in the way I want - and not how society deems fit.

According to Julie Battilana’s and Marissa Kimsey’s theory of social change roles, Kuoth seems predominantly to be an orchestrator. Everywhere she goes, she brings together people to represent and retell the stories of marginalized communities - whether it’s in modeling, The Good Lie, or Janubi Butters.

3. Deepak Ramola, Founder of Project FUEL

“We become great at creating scarcity lists. What are you abundant in? Always enter a room with that.”

Deepak Ramola is an exceptional example of what it means to be an interesting change maker. Over the course of his two classes, he taught us how to fall in love with our problem, frame it from the lens of excitement, view our lives in terms of our ‘rich lists’ and recognize our borrowed and embodied power. Something I truly appreciated from Deepak is his appreciation of the value every person carries - which led him to create the World Wisdom Map.



As an aspiring change-maker in the education space, collaborating with other stakeholders relevant to the problem will be essential to my success. This is why Deepak's honoring of each person's wisdom in his case study has been pivotal for me. I now aim to base the foundation of my solution on feedback and the wisdom of others.

Furthermore, Deepak's relationship to power reframed the way that I think of power. He gains from knowledge and power of others- and in a way, makes it his own power. His work with the world wisdom map symbolizes this relationship - demonstrating that the power of others can be used a tool of furthering social change. Deepak is primarily an innovator - and his repository of people's wisdom from all over the world is evidence of that.

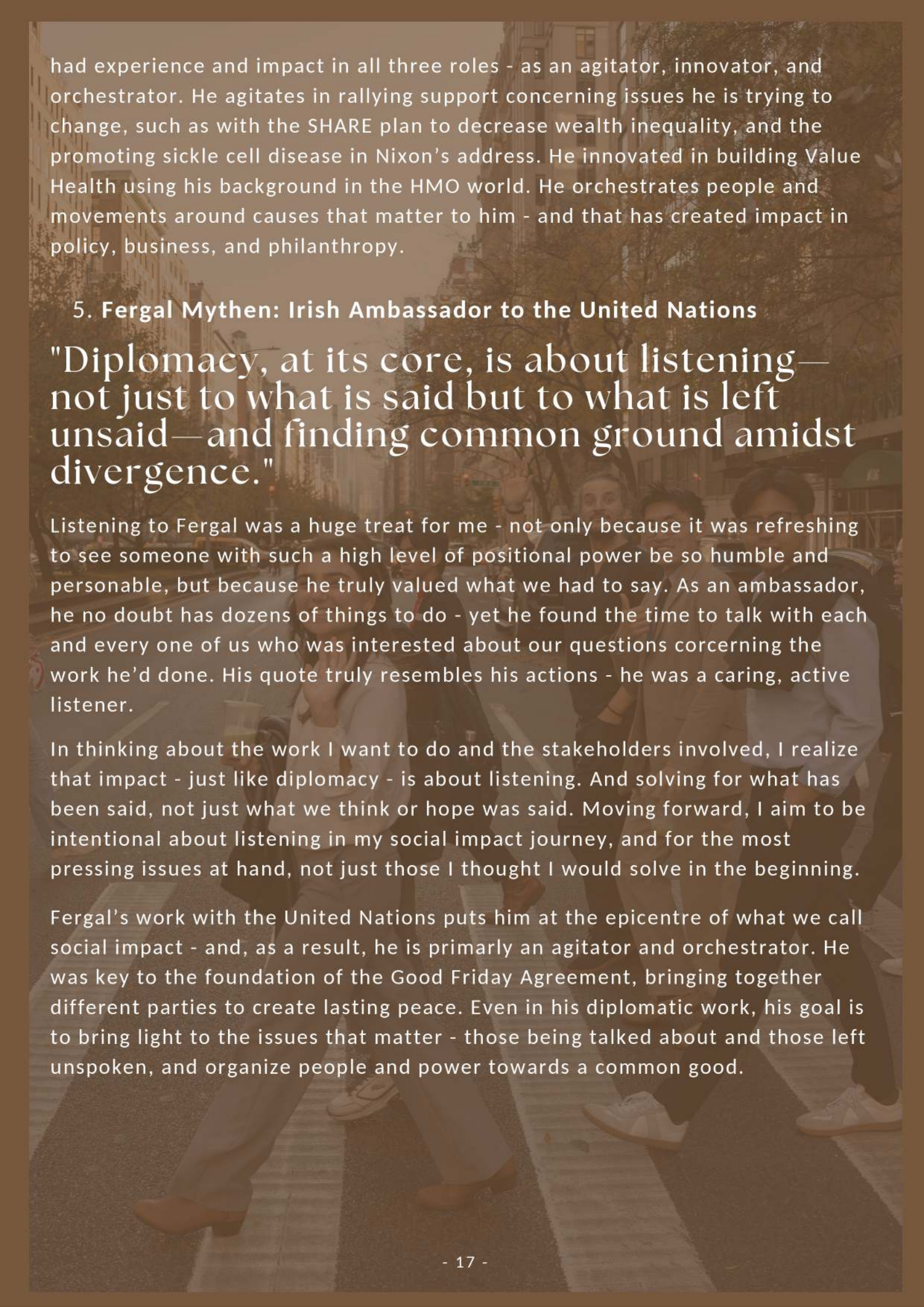
4. Bob Patricelli: Entrepreneur, Investor, Philanthropist

“A lot of young people get dazzled by touching their senator's arm. Isn't it better to be one rather than serve one? Figure out a way to become one. You may have to be an apprentice, but that's okay, it's not the goal. The goal is to be the boss.”

It was a wonderful opportunity to speak with Bob, being from an earlier generation and having learned many lessons along the journey of his full life. Something I really learned from Bob is the value of mentorship in accelerating a person's journey. He spoke so highly of the mentors he met along his path, including Secretary of State Dean Rusk, his mentor during the White House Fellows program - as well as Senator Jacob Javits who hired him right after.

These mentors were instrumental to his journey, as well as the powerful network of people he built along the way. As a result, Bob is a strong example of institutional and relational power. In working with people in positions of power, he learned how to influence policy, which paved his path to influencing policy himself. From working in Cigna to creating the SHARE plan, his path to impact has been paved by building relationships and connections with people, and leveraging his institutional power to create positive impact.

I would say Bob is primarily an orchestrator - bringing together people and groups in various sectors to create change in those respective spaces. He has



had experience and impact in all three roles - as an agitator, innovator, and orchestrator. He agitates in rallying support concerning issues he is trying to change, such as with the SHARE plan to decrease wealth inequality, and the promoting sickle cell disease in Nixon's address. He innovated in building Value Health using his background in the HMO world. He orchestrates people and movements around causes that matter to him - and that has created impact in policy, business, and philanthropy.

5. Fergal Mythen: Irish Ambassador to the United Nations

"Diplomacy, at its core, is about listening—not just to what is said but to what is left unsaid—and finding common ground amidst divergence."

Listening to Fergal was a huge treat for me - not only because it was refreshing to see someone with such a high level of positional power be so humble and personable, but because he truly valued what we had to say. As an ambassador, he no doubt has dozens of things to do - yet he found the time to talk with each and every one of us who was interested about our questions concerning the work he'd done. His quote truly resembles his actions - he was a caring, active listener.

In thinking about the work I want to do and the stakeholders involved, I realize that impact - just like diplomacy - is about listening. And solving for what has been said, not just what we think or hope was said. Moving forward, I aim to be intentional about listening in my social impact journey, and for the most pressing issues at hand, not just those I thought I would solve in the beginning.

Fergal's work with the United Nations puts him at the epicentre of what we call social impact - and, as a result, he is primarily an agitator and orchestrator. He was key to the foundation of the Good Friday Agreement, bringing together different parties to create lasting peace. Even in his diplomatic work, his goal is to bring light to the issues that matter - those being talked about and those left unspoken, and organize people and power towards a common good.

Power Analysis

PERSONAL POWER

FROM A YOUNG AGE, MY PARENTS INSTILLED A STRONG SENSE OF IDENTITY IN ME. THEIR CONSTANT REMINDER TO “REMEMBER THE CHILD OF WHO YOU ARE” GROUNDED MY CONFIDENCE AND SHAPED MY PERSONAL POWER. THIS ALIGNS WITH JULIE BATTILANA’S ASSERTION THAT PERSONAL TRAITS, SHAPED BY LIVED EXPERIENCES, ARE SIGNIFICANT SOURCES OF POWER (BATTILANA ET AL., 2017). GROWING UP IN LAGOS EXPOSED ME TO SYSTEMIC INEQUITIES, MOTIVATING MY PASSION FOR EDUCATIONAL REFORM. MY EMPATHY AND EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE, HONED THROUGH NAVIGATING COMPLEX SOCIAL DYNAMICS, HAVE BECOME CENTRAL TO HOW I CONNECT WITH OTHERS AND DRIVE CHANGE.

DEEPAK RAMOLA’S INSIGHTS ON “EMBODIED POWER” REDEFINED MY UNDERSTANDING OF PERSONAL POWER. HIS CONCEPT—“EMBODIED POWER IS WHO YOU ARE, HOW YOU MAKE PEOPLE FEEL, AND HOW YOU FEEL ABOUT YOURSELF”—EMPHASIZES SELF-AWARENESS AND INTENTIONALITY IN CHANGEMAKING (RAMOLA, 2023). DEEPAK’S “RICH LISTS” EXERCISE REFRAMED MY PERCEPTION OF SCARCITY INTO ONE OF ABUNDANCE, WHILE HIS WISDOM MAP DEMONSTRATED THE VALUE OF COLLECTIVE INSIGHTS. THESE TOOLS HAVE TAUGHT ME THAT PERSONAL POWER EXTENDS BEYOND INDIVIDUAL CAPACITY TO INTEGRATING COMMUNITY WISDOM. MOVING FORWARD, I AIM TO USE THIS POWER TO CREATE COLLABORATIVE SPACES WHERE SHARED WISDOM DRIVES SUSTAINABLE EDUCATIONAL SOLUTIONS.

RELATIONAL POWER

BUILDING RELATIONSHIPS HAS ALWAYS COME NATURALLY TO ME. MY CURIOSITY ABOUT OTHERS’ EXPERIENCES ALLOWED ME TO FOSTER DEEP CONNECTIONS, REFLECTING MARSHALL GANZ’S VIEW THAT

RELATIONAL POWER LIES IN NETWORKS AND HUMAN CONNECTIONS. SHIV SOIN'S WORK WITH TREEAGE AND THE 2019 CLIMATE STRIKE, MOBILIZING OVER 300,000 PEOPLE, EXEMPLIFIES HOW RELATIONAL NETWORKS AMPLIFY COLLECTIVE MOVEMENTS. HIS FOCUS ON YOUTH ENGAGEMENT AND INTERSECTIONAL ADVOCACY HIGHLIGHTED THE IMPORTANCE OF SHARED PURPOSE IN FOSTERING COLLABORATION.

REFLECTING ON MY OWN JOURNEY, SHIV'S EXAMPLE INSPIRED ME TO THINK CRITICALLY ABOUT SUSTAINING MEANINGFUL RELATIONSHIPS IN ADVOCACY. RELATIONAL POWER FOR ME IS ROOTED IN EMPATHY AND TRUST. JULIE BATTILANA'S FRAMEWORK ON NETWORK CENTRALITY COMPLEMENTS THIS, EMPHASIZING THE ROLE OF BRIDGING DISCONNECTED GROUPS IN DRIVING INNOVATION (BATTILANA & CASCIARO, 2013). ADDITIONALLY, AMBASSADOR FERGA MYTHEN'S HUMILITY DURING DISCUSSIONS UNDERScoreD THE IMPORTANCE OF LISTENING AND RESPECT IN BUILDING TRUST. MOVING FORWARD, I AIM TO DEEPEN MY RELATIONAL POWER BY CULTIVATING INCLUSIVE NETWORKS THAT PRIORITIZE EQUITY AND AMPLIFY MARGINALIZED VOICES.

POSITIONAL POWER

WHILE POSITIONAL POWER IS NOT MY STRONGEST SOURCE, MY LEADERSHIP ROLES HAVE SHOWN ME ITS POTENTIAL. BOB PATRICELLI'S CAREER TRAJECTORY UNDERScoreD HOW PRIVILEGE AND NETWORKS AMPLIFY POSITIONAL POWER BUT ALSO HIGHLIGHTED THE IMPORTANCE OF LEVERAGING SUCH POWER FOR BROADER IMPACT. INSPIRED BY THIS, I AIM TO BUILD POSITIONAL POWER THROUGH LEADERSHIP ROLES IN EDUCATIONAL INITIATIVES WHILE REMAINING COMMITTED TO EQUITY AND EMPATHY.

KUOTH'S REFLECTIONS ON USING STORYTELLING TO CHALLENGE DOMINANT NARRATIVES RESHAPED MY UNDERSTANDING OF POSITIONAL POWER AS A TOOL FOR ADVOCACY. HER PHILOSOPHY OF "OWNING YOUR STORY" RESONATED DEEPLY, PARTICULARLY AS A YOUNG AFRICAN NAVIGATING U.S. ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SPACES. POSITIONAL POWER, FOR ME, IS NOT AN ENDPOINT BUT A MEANS TO CREATE OPPORTUNITIES FOR OTHERS. JULIE BATTILANA'S THEORY OF ORCHESTRATION ALIGNS WITH THIS, EMPHASIZING USING FORMAL AUTHORITY TO FOSTER COLLABORATION ACROSS SECTORS (BATTILANA ET AL., 2017).

the pathway



EDUCATION FOR EQUALITY

*education for
equality*

SOLUTION STATEMENT

“ We will create an initiative that provides free educational resources and free online tutoring for underprivileged children in Nigeria (and the world at large), because they need access to empowering opportunities early on, to escape becoming economically disadvantaged adults. We hope to provide these empowering opportunities through education.”

Multiple Paths to Impact

1. Teaching Fellowship

A teaching fellowship where teachers are equipped with the skills to educate students properly, thereby increasing the quality of education. This may not be the best solution, as there are many teachers available currently, they are largely under resourced.

2. Fundraising to Improve Classroom Facilities

Classroom facilities can be improved can be improved through fundraising efforts, which would mean a higher quality of education and greater capacity to educate more children. This may not be the most efficient solution short-term due to high implementation costs (time and money) and bureaucratic bottlenecks.

3. Lobbying for Better Policies and Stricter Implementation

Politically lobbying for better policies and stricter implementation of established laws on free compulsory education for all children could solve the problem. Corruption at multiple levels of governance and law enforcement make this unfeasible, however.

Scale Implementation and Comparable Solutions



Creating impact using the paths stated above can be difficult due to the reasons stated above. This is why we created the plan Education for Equality: an online educational platform that would bring school to the children.

This solution undercuts the problems with governmental bureaucracy and the timing required to build more schools, as well as the resources required to maintain them.

Using this model, students everywhere will be able to access free, quality education, despite the infrastructural challenges and lack of internet access endured by many Nigerians. We aim to grow by implementing change through an online learning platform, and distributing it through offline open-source software. The model is explained in more detail in the action plan below,

Organizations to Emulate:

Renowned for its pioneering use of data analytics, Khan Academy provides a model of real-time progress tracking that ensures students receive personalized learning experiences. Education for Equality aims to emulate the following key aspects of Khan Academy's approach as it we scale:

- **Real-Time Feedback:** *By implementing analytics tools, Education for Equality will track student progress in literacy and numeracy, identifying areas of struggle to provide tailored resources and recommendations.*
- **Adaptive Learning:** *Using a digital platform, Education for Equality will offer adaptive lesson plans that adjust based on student performance, ensuring that learning is both challenging and achievable for every child.*
- **Engagement Metrics:** *Education for Equality will monitor student engagement levels through platform usage data, enabling interventions when necessary to maintain high participation rates.*
- **Educator Insights:** *Just as Khan Academy equips teachers with detailed performance dashboards, Education for Equality will provide actionable insights into student progress, helping us tailor our teaching strategies effectively.*

Plan of Action

Online Learning Platform: Education for Equality consists of an online learning platform containing basic educational curricula from ages 5- 16. It will include teaching videos for all basic subjects, including KS1 - KS4 of the British primary and secondary curriculum, on required subjects including math, english, and science. In future iterations, more subjects can be added.

The Tab Project: A digital literacy initiative that provides tablets preloaded with educational content tailored to Nigeria's curriculum.

The Book Run: A community-driven project to distribute textbooks and learning materials to under-resourced schools.

Objectives & Outcomes

- To increase access to quality education for 100 children across rural and urban areas in Nigeria within the first pilot.
- To create a scalable model that integrates digital resources and community involvement.
- To build digital literacy and decentralize educational access.

Plan

The program will use an open-source platform, Kolibri, which enables access to educational content without wifi connectivity. All that is required is a central platform/console that will have the platform's educational curricula and broadcast it wirelessly to tablets within the vicinity.

The Book Run will be an annual event during which quality unneeded books will be donated by people and given to children who are not in school, as well as under-resourced schools. Cooperation from community leaders might be a challenge, but the majority of parents whose children are not in school would still like them to benefit from one form of education or another. A detailed field analysis would need to be conducted to identify the areas of needed and most effective strategies for implementation.

Proposed Timeline

Field Analysis (June 2025 - September 2025)

- Conduct interviews across vulnerable communities in Lagos, Nigeria, inquiring of parents if they would like their children to gain a formal education, and how that would look like.
- Begin publicizing the Book Run and partnering with local organizations, well-resourced schools and communities, to begin a book donation drive for the event.

- Evaluate the feasibility of giving tablets to young children within these communities, and pivot strategies if necessary.
- Begin scouting for local representatives who will monitor the activities and progress of education for equality in chosen local government areas in Lagos, Nigeria. Given funding, these would be payroll staff.
- Work with educational professionals at Wesleyan and at home to build the curriculum for the website and learning materials
- Apply for funding and resources at The Patricelli Center, African Leadership Academy, Kolibri, as well as other non-profit organizations.

Pilot Phase I (October 2025 - January 2026)

- Select 2 local government areas for the pilot of the program. Position a local representative in each area
- Receive written signatures of parents who enroll their children in the program - they are legally prohibited to stop their children from participating once they begin.
- Perform a test of the website with a focus group of students at Wesleyan and in Nigeria. Note points for improvement.
- Partner with Kolibri to review educational curricula and apply for their hardware grants program.

Pilot Phase II (February 2026 - April 2026)

- Implement feedback points from focus groups and upload education for equality software.
- Partner with the EcoExcel, Lagos state's initiative to get children back into school, to pilot the platform in their districts.
- Evaluate strengths and weaknesses of pilot phase I and integrate strategy for improvement

The Book Run (June 2026)

- Execute the Book Run for 2026.

My Mission and Vision Moving Forward

My Mission

Ensure the provision of free, quality education to children across the African continent, starting with Lagos, Nigeria.

My Vision

A Nigeria where every child has access to free, quality education and the opportunities that come with it, regardless of their socioeconomic status.

The Pathway

Education for Equality aims to become a model for how technology and community engagement can bridge educational gaps. Long term, the program aspires to:

- Reach the most underserved students across Nigeria.
- Establish partnerships with international organizations to replicate the model in other underserved regions.
- Create a network of empowered educators and youth leaders who advocate for systemic change.

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